

I wasn't sure I was hearing him correctly. I asked him how much he was investing, and he replied, "A quarter-million. I already wrote the check last week." When I asked him what his wife thought about all this, he told me that he hadn't talked to her about it. When I asked him what the company's projections looked like, he told me he hadn't seen them. When I asked him who else was backing the company, he told me he didn't know.

The look on my face started to chip away the excitement that was plastered across his. I looked at him and said, "So, let me get this straight. You invested \$250,000 into a company you know nothing about that wants to make a product most people aren't interested in, and you did it without discussing it with your wife?" He nodded. I leaned back and said, "Well, good luck telling your wife that you just threw away a quarter-million dollars."

Of course, this sports star lost his money. That "investment" never went anywhere, and he had some *serious* explaining to do to his wife. The only "opportunity" that experience gave him was the chance to learn some hard lessons about risky investments. While stories like this can be funny and get a lot of attention, this isn't *normal* behavior for the vast majority of millionaires across the country. If you watched television or believed everything you read online, though, you'd think this is *exactly* what most millionaires do. You'd think they take gigantic risks on stupid investments every day, just lucking their way into enough wins to keep their wealth growing.

Almost all the millionaires we talked to in our research shared similar stories of building wealth slowly, avoiding unnecessary risks, and doing the same simple—almost boring—investing practices over and over across many years. If you want to become a millionaire yourself, it's time to let go of the wide-eyed, get-rich-quick view of investing that leads most people off a cliff. Instead, you need to do what most millionaires do: understand risk, pick investments that balance the risk and reward you're comfortable with, and never get distracted with "opportunities" from people who don't know what they're talking about. Let's dig into all this and bust this myth for good.